



Scatter diagrams

SCATTER DIAGRAMS PRESENT INFORMATION FROM TWO SETS OF DATA AND REVEAL THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THEM.

What is a scatter diagram?

A scatter diagram is a graph made from two sets of data. Each set of data is measured on an axis of the graph. The data always appears in pairs—one value will need to be read up from the x axis, the other read across from the y axis. A point is marked where each pair meet. The pattern made by the points shows whether there is any connection, or correlation, between the two sets of data.

SEE ALSO

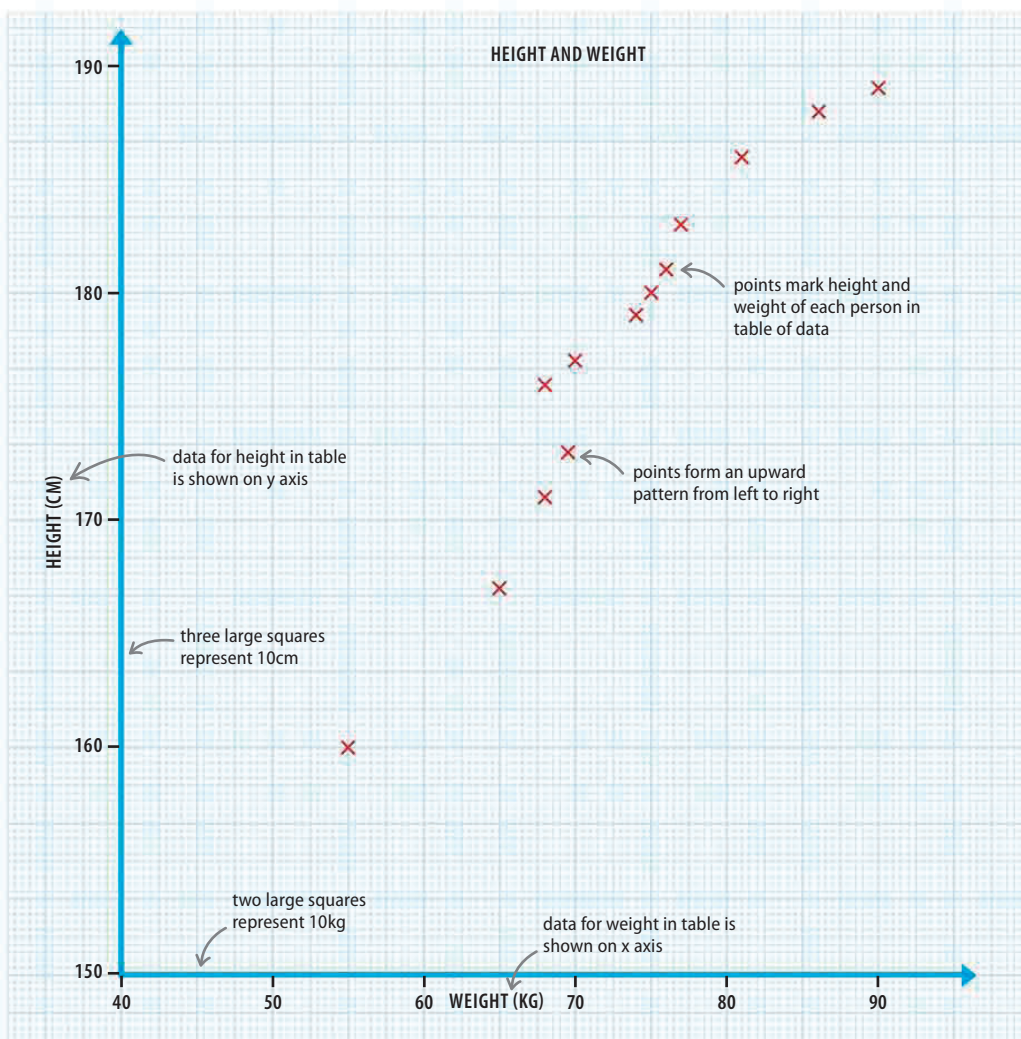
◀ 204–205 Collecting and organizing data

◀ 212–213 Line graphs

▽ Table of data

This table shows two sets of data—the height and weight of 13 people. With each person's height the corresponding weight measurement is given.

Height (cm)	173	171	189	167	183	181	179	160	177	180	188	186	176
Weight (kg)	69	68	90	65	77	76	74	55	70	75	86	81	68



◁ Plotting the points

Draw a vertical axis (y) and a horizontal axis (x) on graph paper. Mark out measurements for each set of data in the table along the axes. Read each corresponding height and weight in from its axis and mark where they meet. Do not join the points marked.

◁ Positive correlation

The pattern of points marked between the two axes shows an upward trend from left to right. An upward trend is known as positive correlation. The correlation between the two sets of data in this example is that as height increases, so does weight.